



Turing Pardoned

How long does it take to get a royal pardon? Alan Turing found out the hard way. <http://dgit.in/7ur1n9>



Mind Wipe?

Has memory wiping tech now become a reality? Maybe. To know more <http://dgit.in/r34dm1mnd>

Industry Connect

brand fidelity across all different devices. So if I'm a British Airways or I'm a Tata or whatever, I want my brand communication to look as crisp and as clear and as legible irrespective of end-device that the consumer or user is using. So that challenge is quite huge and it exists across screens like handhelds or screens found inside cockpits. Monotype has done a lot of work in the area of rendering legible text across different screen-sizes, screen quality, and memory availability. That business line call 'Display Imaging' we have our products deployed in automobiles like Ford, Hyundai etc. So the display technology ensures that all content irrespective of language comes across as crisp as it should be on very high resolution or on large screen.

Q So for these interfaces – say in-flight entertainment – do you just develop the fonts for the interface or you work closely with the partners involved right down to the display technology itself?

So let's take the example of automotive. In automotive you've done a lot of work in terms of fonts as well. We have very specific set of font that we know work very well in the automotive sector. We did this very in-depth study with MIT to figure out in terms of time and attention of the driver is there a difference when it comes to fonts. Every minute that needed the attention and the distraction can cause problems so we've fonts that we've designed and researched on over the years that work very well in certain industries. Beyond that, we also have technology that make fonts legible and clear. Our tech is not restricted to just these in fact Amazon Kindle device uses our display text rendering technology as well. Also, almost 9 out of 10 laser printer manufacturers out there world wide have our print driver technology.

Q What about you know Indic fonts what monotypes position there?

The Company has been in Indic fonts from so long time from the 1960s. In fact, the number of fonts that are quite heavily used in India. We were actively involved in the Typography Day in IIT Guwahati last year and a font called Frutiger Devanagari. We see a of brands are looking to have complementary Indic and Latin fonts for

their brands. You know there's a lot of vernacular population that doesn't understand English. We see indie languages as extremely important and there are complex scripts that pose challenges to render on screen. It's an area where a lot of work needs to be done and will be done over the coming years.

Q Do you commonly work with OEMs, you know helping them create regional packs, for example Apple recently added bangla support from iOS 6 onwards right?

Yeah, so we work with OEMs when it comes to screens, mobile devices, say Samsung. We also work with independent software vendors like Google and Android, and Apple device, so yes; both Apple and Google are our customers.

Q Considering today's mobile devices is there a type of font and display technology that is best suited for reading text?

When a font works very well on a given type of screen, it is because there's some technology that is embedded in the font. There is a technology called 'hinting' where we create add-ons to a font so that it looks well on low resolution screens. There are lots of technology elements so that font looks better and very clear on different screen types. In terms of the future, I think, one of our focus areas is to bring incredible global fonts – one of the largest libraries out there – onto the fingertips of creative professionals. Skyfonts will be doing that. It allows you to try fonts anywhere on the cloud and our library, and try them out in your designs so you might be working in InDesign or PowerPoint or whatever tool you might be using. If you like it, you can try it for free, and if you like it, you can go for a subscription or any other suitable payment model that you want.

Q And what is the kind of DRM being used here? If someone wants to just go ahead and use it in their final production, what stops them?

See ultimately when the file download is done, the font is sort of encapsulated by our own technology. You don't have to delete it, after a few minutes it will disappear. But, this is a very huge relief for creative community because this ability to use a

font that was created yesterday by some iconic designer, which is not available to anybody around the world, within minutes. That's huge! As it reduces the time in market tremendously.

Q This raises another question: we have thousands of fonts packs on torrents and all available freely. Does this kind of piracy affect your business at all?

Any form of art or technology or IP there's always a dark side, right? And it happens with music, it happens with arts, so yes, definitely it's the area of concern. Now having said that, the market is becoming easy, right? Let's look at it this way: some people were doing this because they do not have easy access legally to get fonts quickly. A designer gets a few days, a few weeks to get a production or a new creative done. Now, with things like SkyFonts easily available the logic is, what's the point? I've a legal way that's easy so why bother doing illegal things? Similarly, the models of payment have changed tremendously now. We have payment models that suit every requirement, and its not just tailored only for the high-end requirement only. So for web fonts there's a little bit of a cost up front but most of the cost is by usage. As people are using that font, they're paying so that reduces the sort of overall front-end cost for the designer or firm that is using it.

Q Is there any big name brand or website that I would know of that's using your fonts?

There are pretty much iconic brands out there, if you know Timberland, Nike, Adidas, Samsung, American Idol uses it, if you talk about our web-fonts, huge brands are using it. If you talk about fonts then pretty much any big company in the world uses it.

Q What are your operations in India like?

We decided about 16-18 months back that this will be our innovation centre globally. So we're working on developing technology that we talk about. We are developing and designing fonts as well in Noida, so our guys take a lot of pride in doing this here. We want to share that at have people come over and see what we are building, interact etc. I am giving an open invitation to come and see for yourself what's going on. 